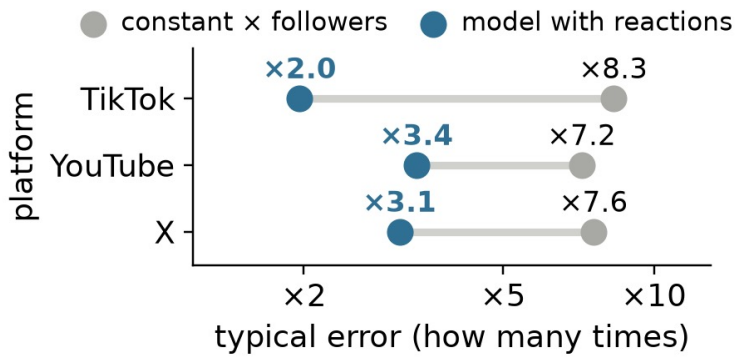
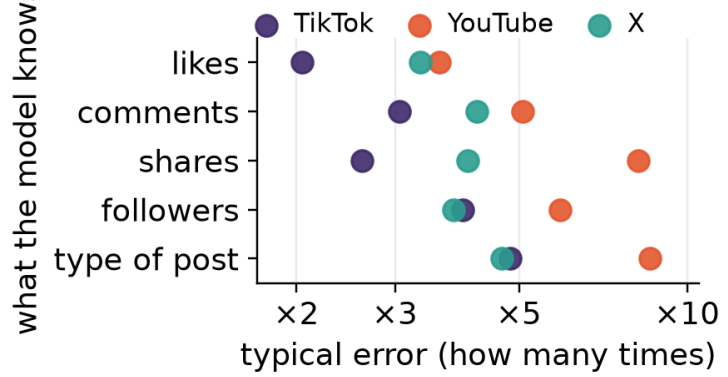
Likes say far more about views than the follower count

How far off are we?



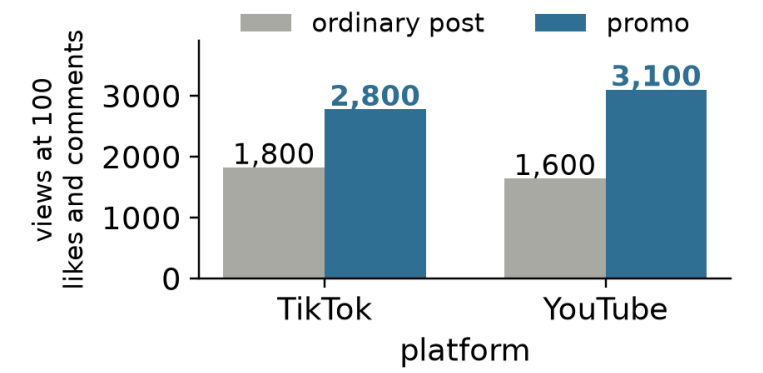
Constant × followers: ×7-8. Model with reactions: ×2-3. On X Brand24 about ×12, ours about ×3.

What matters most?



Likes alone go furthest. The type of post says almost nothing.

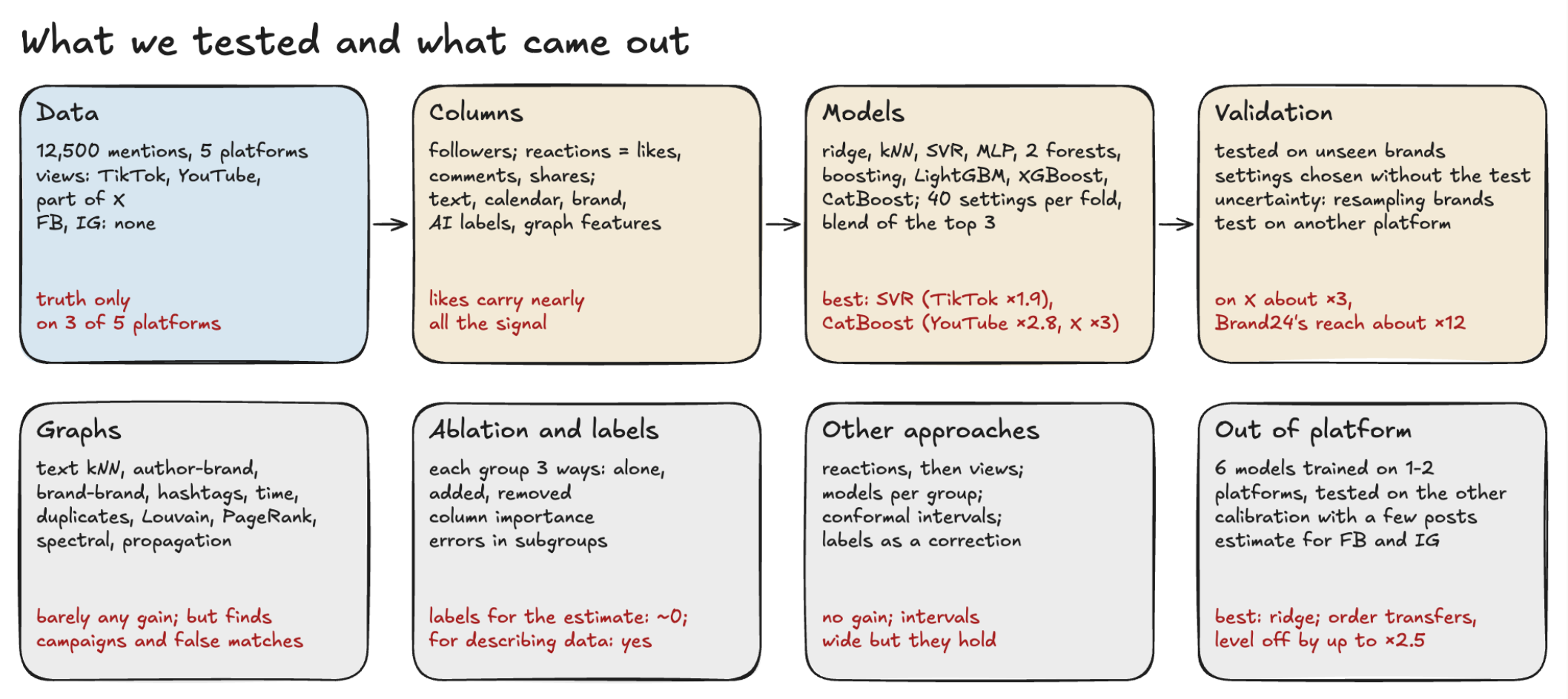
Does the kind of post help?



AI labels barely help the estimate, but promo gets 1.5-1.9× the views.

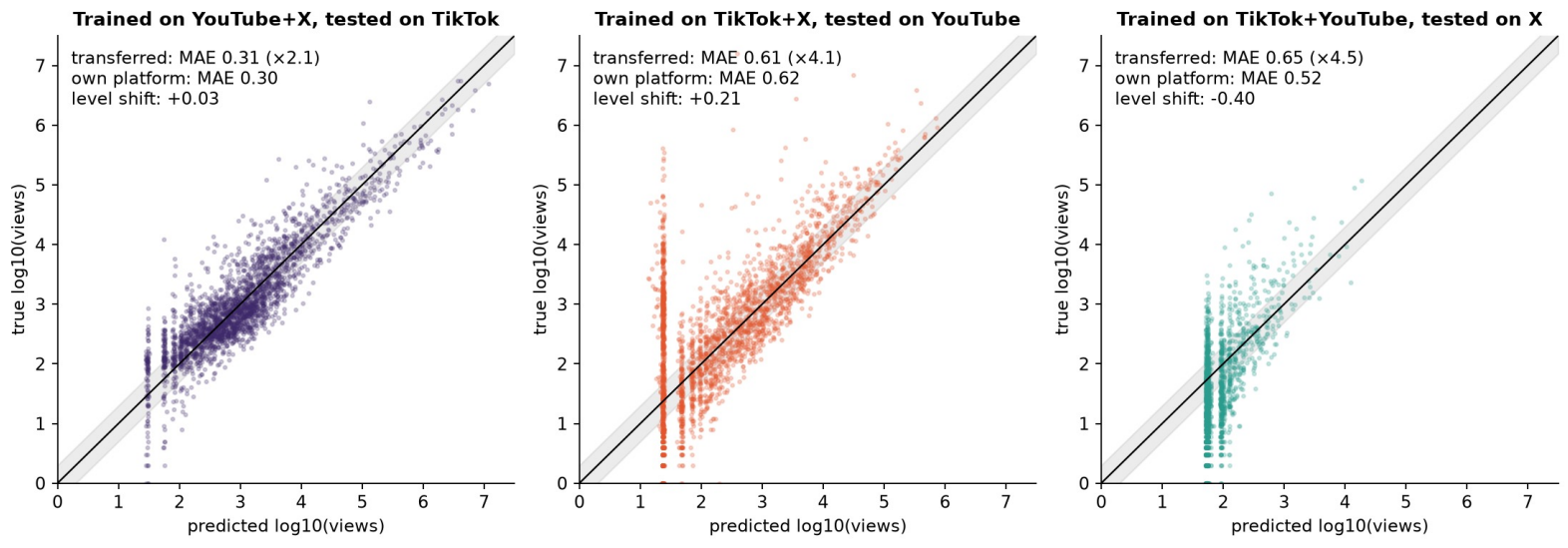
"Off by ×3" = typically 3 times too high or too low. Reactions = likes, comments, shares. Tested on brands the model has not seen.

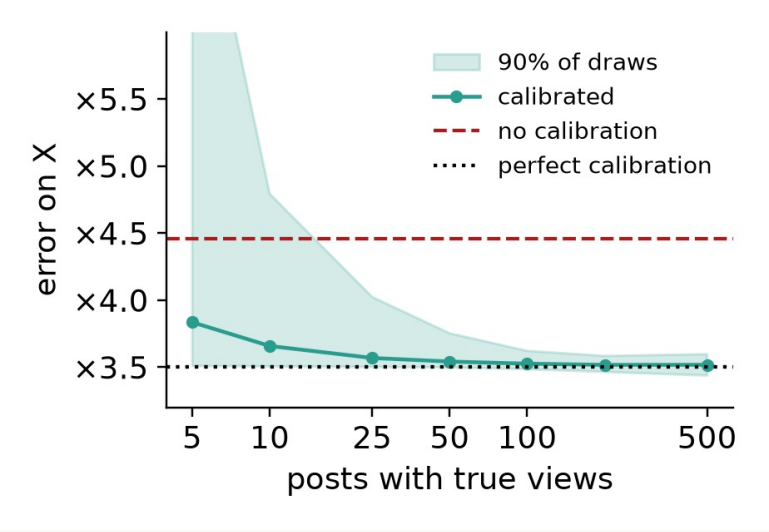
We tested 10 kinds of model: the best are off 2-3 times, and extra data and graphs barely change that



Best: SVR (TikTok), CatBoost (YouTube, X). 40 settings per model.

A model from another platform ranks posts well but can miss the scale; about 50 posts fix that





Another platform

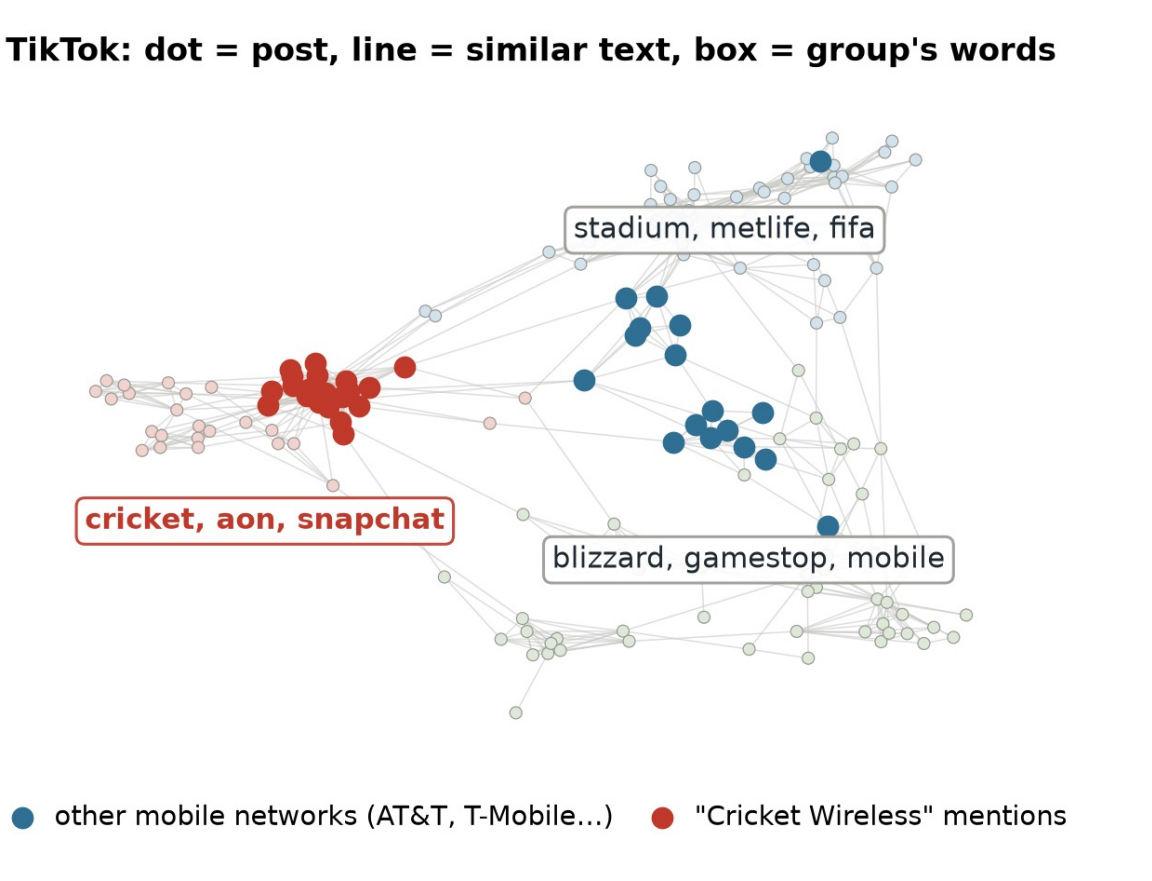
TikTok ×2.1, YouTube ×4.1: nearly as on own data. X: ×4.5 instead of ×3.3, as everything is about 2.5× too high.

A small sample is enough

50 posts from X: error ×4.5 → ×3.5. FB and IG need such a sample.

Ridge trained on two platforms, tested on the third. Calibration tested only where the truth is known.

Graphs barely improve the estimate, but they show what is really in the data



How: each post links to its 10 most similar texts. Louvain splits the graph into groups; the boxed words say what a group is about.

False match: all 20 "Cricket Wireless" mentions are in the cricket group, not with mobile networks. By hand: 0 of 20 about the company.

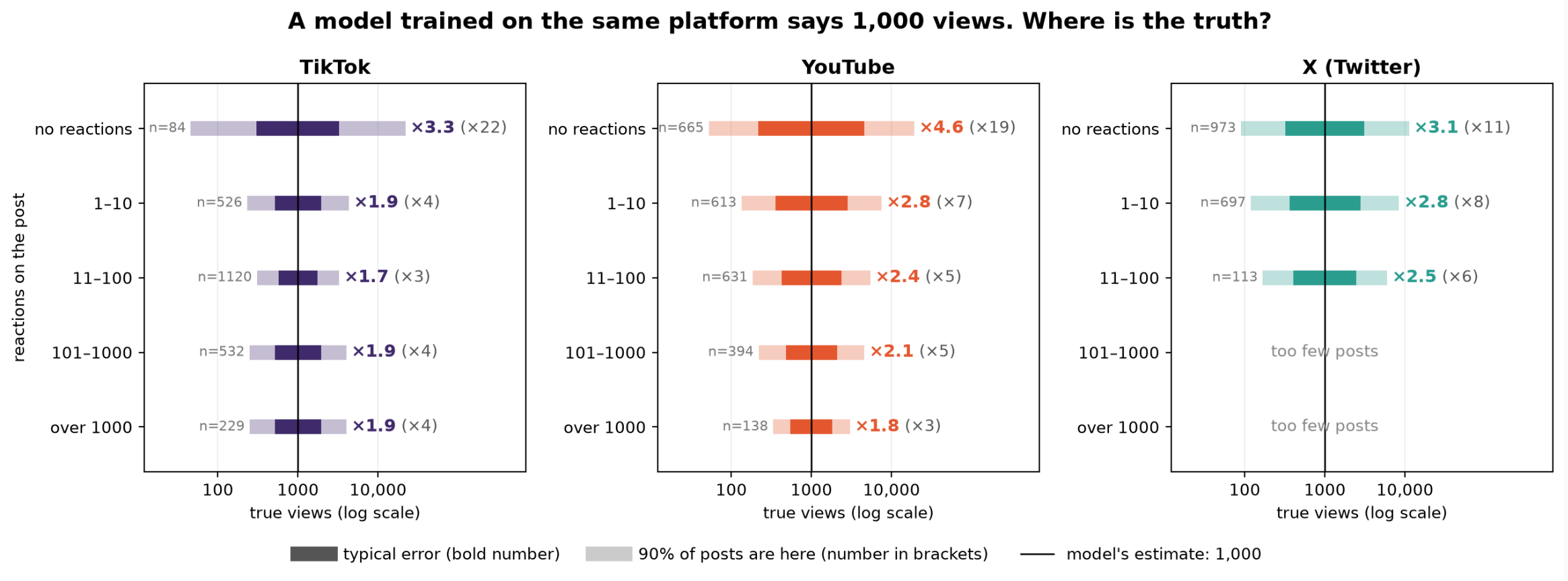
Across all brands: we ask whether a mention's neighbours share its industry. Weakest: Frontier on X (AI), Gap on YouTube (AI), Guardian Life (Minecraft). Candidates, not yet checked by hand.

For the estimate: graphs give at most +0.009.

Brand industries were assigned by an AI model, unchecked. Some candidates are just another language (Decathlon, Avanza), and Cricket Wireless does not score low with this method.

BACKUP · UNCERTAINTY

Without reactions the estimate is uncertain; with reactions the range narrows sharply



CatBoost trained on the same platform. Dark bar: typical error; light: 90% of posts.